AHLI SWITZLER | CASE STUDY 3

A Reusable Voice Check for AI Drafts

I turned my rules for keeping AI-drafted copy from reading as machine-written into a check that runs on everything I send, and that verifies itself by searching the finished text.

THE CHALLENGE

AI drafts carry recognizable tells: stock vocabulary, false-contrast sentences, three-item lists by habit, sentences that all run the same length. Readers spot them fast, and clients notice. Asking a model to avoid them once doesn't hold across a long project.

ROLE AND TOOLS

Solo. Claude skills, which are saved instruction sets the model loads automatically for certain kinds of work.

THE PROCESS

1. I collected the patterns from writer communities and my own drafts, then cut the list to the ones that showed up in my work.
2. I sorted them into banned vocabulary, banned structures, and formatting rules such as no em dashes and straight apostrophes.
3. I wrote them into a skill that triggers on every proposal, essay, post, and piece of client copy, so I never have to restate the rules.
4. I added a verification step. After drafting, the text gets searched for every banned term and mark. A draft written under the rules but never searched doesn't count as checked.

WHAT I CAUGHT AND DECIDED

- Instructions alone reduced the tells without removing them. The search pass is what closed the gap.
- The most common tell in my own past drafts was the "not X, but Y" construction, so it gets its own rule with examples.
- Overcorrecting makes writing stiff. The skill says plainly that long sentences and strong claims are fine, and only filler is out.

THE RESULT

One system that keeps every draft in my voice, from course papers to client copy. It ran on every piece in this portfolio.